KWAME NKRUMAH UNIVERSITY OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY
COLLEGE OF HUMANITIES AND SOCIAL SCIENCES
FACULTY OF SOCIAL SCIENCES

DEPARTMENT OF ENGLISH

ENGL 158: COMMUNICATION SKILLS

LECTURER:
EMAIL:
OFFICE:
OFFICE HOURS:

COURSE DESCRIPTION

This course is designed to continue the process of helping students to become better communicators. Here, the emphasis is on business and technical communication so as to equip students with the relevant tools of communication necessary for functionality in business in a competitive world in which effective communication is crucial for success. Topics such as communication in organization, memos, briefs, letters and CVs, reports, minutes, proposals, oral communication and presentation skills will be taught.

COURSE OUTLINE

WEEK(S)	TOPIC	FURTHER READING
1	Introduction and overview of course **Communication** • Definition • The communication process • Types of communication • Effective communication • Communication breakdown	 Sekyi-Baidoo (2003) Adolinama (2005), pp. 159-179
2	**Communication in Organizations** • Nature of organizational communication • Types of organizational communication • Ways to improve organizational communication	Sekyi-Baidoo (2003) Adolinama (2005), pp. 195-209
3	**Writing as a Process** • Pre-writing stage -From topic selection to outline • Writing stage • Post-writing stage -Editing and proofreading	 Zemach & Rumisek (2005) Adesanya (2007) (Ed)
4	**Oral Presentation Skills** • Stage fright	Adolinama (2005) Ehrlich & Hawes (2003)

	• Types of Oral Speech (Persuasive speech, Vote of Thanks, Proposing a Toast; Introducing a Chairperson; Giving Spontaneous speeches) • Interviews	
5	**Letter Writing** • Formal Letters • Structure • Features (the concept of formality) • Language and style	Sekyi-Baidoo (2003) Adolinama (2005)
6	**Writing a Curriculum Vitae** • What is a CV? • The CV vs. Resume • Types of CV - Traditional/Chronological CV - Skill based/Functional CV - Technical CV • Structure of the CV	Sekyi-Baidoo (2003) Adolinama (2005)
7-8	**Meeting & Minutes Writing** *Meeting* • What is a meeting? • Types of meeting • Notice of meeting • Agenda of meeting • Language, style, and tone (meeting terminologies) *Minutes Writing* • Definition • Types of minute - Narrative - Resolution - Action • Structure of minutes • Layout of minutes • Importance of minutes • Language of minutes	Sekyi-Baidoo (2003) Adolinama (2005)
9-10	**Report Writing** • Definition • Letter of Authorization • Letter of Transmittal • Types of report	Sekyi-Baidoo (2003) Adolinama (2005)

	- Long - Short - Letter - Memorandum • Structure of report • Executive Summary • Language of report	
11	**The Memorandum** • What is a memorandum? • Forms (emails, traditional, SMS, WhatsApp, etc) • Structure • Features / Layout • Uses of memos	Sekyi-Baidoo (2003) Adolinama (2005)
12	**Business Proposal** • Form • Structure • Language • Features	Adolinama (2005), pp. 385-399
13	Revision	
14.	End-of-Semester Examinations	

CLASS ATTENDANCE AND PARTICIPATION

Attendance to lectures is compulsory to all students and at all times. In the event where a student will not be able to attend lectures for various reasons, that student is required to obtain permission from the lecturer through writing. It must be noted, however, that any student who fails to attend lectures without permission on the grounds of ill-health shall have to provide proof in the form of medical report certified by the University medical officer. Full class participation is highly encouraged as it may attract some points.

READING TASKS

In addition to the suggested list of books, students are going to be assigned directed readings on each topic for the week. Each student is expected to read them before coming to class.

EVALUATION

Evaluation will be based on the university-wide stipulated grading policy (i.e. 30% continuous assessment and 70% final examination). The two are broken down as follows:

Continuous Assessment

The continuous assessment will be made up of a mid-semester examination (20 marks) and a

take-home assignment (10 marks) that may be done individually or in a group.

Final Examination

The final examination, which shall comprise multiple-choice questions, will constitute 70%.

ACADEMIC HONESTY

Students are always required to do independent work unless they are told to do otherwise as in the case of group assignments. What this means is that students may share ideas and information on a given exercise but the individual student should own the final work. Second, and most importantly, all external sources used in any work must be duly acknowledged since failure to do so will amount to plagiarism.

READING LIST

Adesanya, F. (2007) (Ed.). *The art of proofreading*. Illorin: Glory Prints.

Adolinama, P. P. (2005). *Communication skills for university students*. Accra: ANEST Company Limited

Alred, G. J., Brusaw, C.T. & Oliu, W. E. (2009). *The business writer's handbook* (9th ed). Boston: Bedford/St. Martin's.

Bargiela-Chiappini, F., Nicherson, C. & Planken, B. (2007). *Business Discourse*. Houndmills: Palgrave Macmillan.

Bergmann, L. F. (1971). *Paragraph rhetoric: A programme in composition*. Boston: Allyn & Bacon Inc.

Nyan, J. K. & Sefanu, J. C. (2003). *Business communication*. Centre for Continuing Education. University of Cape Coast.

Sekyi-Baidoo, Y. (2003). *Learning and communicating (Second Edition)*. Accra: Infinity Graphics Ltd.

Taylor, S. (1991). Communication for business: A practical approach (2nd ed.). Harlow: Longman.

Zemach, D. E. & Rumisek, L. A. (2005). *Academic writing from paragraph to essay*. Oxford: Macmillan.